

shopper's movements and shopping decisions are genuine and actually reflect their normal shopping behavior.

No longer is it enough to observe consumers in the store or while they are shopping. In order to tailor their products to the consumer, companies will even follow their subject home. For their Old Spice line, Procter & Gamble videotaped men (in swimsuits) taking showers, leading to the discovery that many men used their body wash for their hair, which resulted in the creation of a line of combination body wash/shampoo. Kimberly-Clark placed special goggles with tiny cameras on consumers to videotape how they bathed and diapered their children, and Arm & Hammer has entered homes to inspect the insides of refrigerators and the conditions of cat litter boxes. The subjects of the research being done at home are often eager to participate, both for the pay and for the chance to be influential in future product designs. Videotaped results of the research are studied and analyzed by product and package designers and marketing executives.

What do these executives do with all the information they gather in the faux supermarkets, focus studies, and observational research? Understanding the consumer is crucial to a product's success. In order to create promotional strategies that speak directly to the potential buyer, marketers first have to understand the "why" behind their decision to purchase.